

SESSION 6 — SINGLE-LEG STRENGTH AND LANDING CONTROL

60 minutes · strength bias · low nervous-system cost · needs a bench, a curb or step, a band, two cones, a tape measure

Fencing is played on two legs that do entirely different jobs, and the difference between them grows year on year until something complains about it. This session is slow, unilateral and unglamorous: it builds the front knee and the back hip, and it trains landing from a lunge instead of arriving in one.

It is the lightest session in the set. Run it the day after a competition, run it when tired, run it when everything else has been cut. It is also the session that tests left-right asymmetry, which is the one number here worth tracking for years.

Marker for the log: single-leg hop for distance, front leg and back leg, in centimeters. Flag a difference above 10%.

Stop rule: any set where the knee starts tracking inward stops at that rep. Reduce the range and finish the set shallower rather than pushing through.

Minute by minute



TIME	BLOCK	WORK AND REST
0:00-0:05	Raise	3 min jog, 2 min easy rope · easy throughout
0:05-0:10	Mobility	Five movements, one minute each · easy throughout
0:10-0:14	Activation and test	Band, single-leg work, hop test · continuous work
0:14-0:26	A — Split squats and calves	4 rounds of 3 min · 120 s work / 60 s rest
0:26-0:38	B — Hinge and posterior chain	4 rounds of 3 min · 120 s work / 60 s rest
0:38-0:48	C — Landing control	5 rounds of 2 min · 80 s work / 40 s rest
0:48-0:56	D — Fencing transfer	4 rounds of 2 min · 90 s work / 30 s rest
0:56-1:00	Cool-down	Quads, hamstrings, calves · easy throughout

0:00–0:05 · Raise

Easy throughout

Three minutes of easy jogging, then two minutes of relaxed rope or 200 pogo-free skips. Nothing here should feel like effort.

0:05–0:10 · Mobility, one minute each

Easy throughout

1. Couch stretch against the bench, 30 s each side
2. Standing quad stretch with the glute squeezed, 30 s each side
3. Hamstring sweeps, 10 each leg, heel down and toes up
4. Ankle dorsiflexion on the bench, 20 each side, heel glued
5. Deep squat hold, 60 s

0:10–0:14 · Activation and the asymmetry test

Continuous work

- Band monster walks, 10 steps forward and 10 back, twice
- Bodyweight single-leg RDL, 8 each side, very slow
- Calf raises, 15, full range
- Glute bridge march, 10 each side

Then the test, once, before any fatigue: **single-leg hop for distance**, two attempts per leg, landing stuck for two seconds or the attempt does not count. Take off from a cone, drop the second cone at the better heel landing, and measure between them with the tape. Log both legs. A gap wider than 10% is the thing this whole session exists to close, and it closes over months, not weeks.

0:14–0:26 · Block A — Split squats and calves

4 × 120 s work / 60 s rest

Four rounds of three minutes: work through both movements, rest the remainder.

- **12 split squats each side.** Rounds 1 and 2 with both feet on the ground; rounds 3 and 4 with the rear foot up on the bench. Torso upright, front shin vertical at the bottom, weight through the whole front foot.
- **12 single-leg calf raises each side** off a curb or step edge, full stretch at the bottom, two-second squeeze at the top.

Easier: hold a post for balance and halve the depth. Harder: hold a loaded bag or two full water bottles, or add a three-second lower.

0:26–0:38 · Block B — Hinge and posterior chain

4 × 120 s work / 60 s rest

Four rounds of three minutes.

- **10 single-leg RDLs each side.** Hips square, back flat, reach the free leg straight behind. Slow down, faster up.
- **5 Nordic curl negatives.** Feet hooked under the bench, knees padded on a folded towel, lower as slowly as you can and push off with the hands. If that is not available yet, do 10 hamstring walkouts lying on your back with heels on the bench.

- **15 hip thrusts** with shoulders on the bench, two-second squeeze at the top.

The back leg drives the lunge and the hamstrings stop it. This block is the one that keeps a fencer available in March.

0:38–0:48 · Block C — Landing control



5 × 80 s work / 40 s rest

Five rounds of two minutes: work, then rest the remainder.

- **6 step-down eccentrics each side.** Stand on the bench on one leg, lower over three seconds until the other heel taps the ground, stand back up with the top leg. Do not drop.
- **6 skater hops each side,** sticking every landing for two full seconds before the next. Quiet, controlled, knee over the middle of the foot.

Rounds 4 and 5: close your eyes for the two-second hold on the skater landings. Balance without vision is what the last point of a bout feels like.

0:48–0:56 · Block D — Fencing transfer



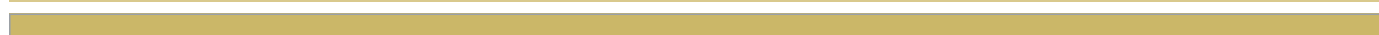
4 × 90 s work / 30 s rest

Four rounds of two minutes.

- **8 slow lunges,** three seconds in the extended position, alternating the recovery: forward on one rep, backward on the next. The front heel lands first, the back foot does not rotate, the back arm stays quiet.
- **30 s en garde hold** at the end of each round, sitting a little lower than is comfortable.
- Rest the remainder.

Because they are slow, these lunges show everything that speed hides. Anything you cannot do at three seconds, you are not really doing at half a second.

0:56–1:00 · Cool-down



Easy throughout

Walk 60 s, then couch stretch 45 s each side, seated hamstring 30 s each side, calf 30 s each side. Finish with a minute of slow breathing.

Log line

date · 06 single-leg · who · hop front __ cm · hop back __ cm · gap __% · felt __/10